



Top position: Kirsty Coventry's victory comes a year after the Paris 2024 Olympics achieved full gender parity, reinforcing the IOC's commitment to diversity and progress. GETTY IMAGES

"This is a powerful statement. It shows that we are truly global, that we have evolved into an organisation open to diversity, and that we will continue on this path over the next eight years," she said.

In the election, runner-up Juan Antonio Samaranch Jr secured 28 votes, while France's David Lappartient and Japan's Morinari Watanabe each received four. Prince Feisal al Hussein of Jordan and Sweden's Johan Eliasch both won two votes.

Already a member of the IOC executive board and widely considered the preferred candidate of outgoing president Thomas Bach, Coventry's tenure will last at least eight years.

During her campaign, she pledged to modernise the IOC, promote sustainability, embrace technological advancements, and empower athletes. She also placed particular emphasis on protecting women's sport, supporting a blanket ban on transgender women competing in female Olympic events.

Coventry's sporting accomplishments

Olympic Games

Gold Medals:

- 2004 – 200m Backstroke
- 2008 – 200m Backstroke

Silver Medals:

- 2004 – 100m Backstroke
- 2008 – 200m Individual Medley, 400m Individual Medley, 100m Backstroke

Bronze Medal:

- 2004 – 200m Individual Medley
- Competed in 2000 and 2016

World Championships

Gold Medals:

- 2005 – 100m Backstroke, 200m Backstroke
- 2009 – 200m Backstroke

Silver Medals:

- 2005 – 200m Individual Medley, 400m Individual Medley
- 2007 – 200m Backstroke, 200m Individual Medley
- 2009 – 400m Individual Medley

World Cup

Silver Medal:

- 2010 – 200m Individual Medley

Bronze Medals:

- 2010 – 200m Backstroke, 200m Individual Medley

African Games — 2015

Gold Medals:

- 200m Backstroke
- 200m Individual Medley
- 100m Backstroke

Summary of Coventry's vision

Harness the Power of Sport

Prioritising athlete well-being, including mental health and post-career opportunities.

Expanding Olympic Solidarity programs to support underrepresented regions.

Increasing visibility for athletes and sports beyond the Games.

Emphasising innovation, including AI-driven engagement and Olympic E-Sports Games.

Maximise Collaboration and Engagement

Strengthening the role of International Federations (IFs) in

Games planning.

Encouraging open dialogue with stakeholders for better decision-making.

Improving internal and external communication for greater transparency.

Strengthen Partnerships for Mutual Growth

Expanding digital platforms and AI-powered engagement tools.

Increasing accessibility to Olympic content across regions and platforms.

Exploring new revenue models while maintaining the Games' integrity.

Champion Sustainable Development

Promoting environmental responsibility in Olympic infrastructure and operations.

Advancing gender equity, inclusivity, and diversity.

Strengthening the Olympic Refugee Team initiative.

Advance Credibility and Trust

Enforcing zero tolerance for corruption, doping, and unethical behaviour.

Maintaining IOC neutrality amid geopolitical tensions.

Leveraging data-driven transparency measures to enhance governance.